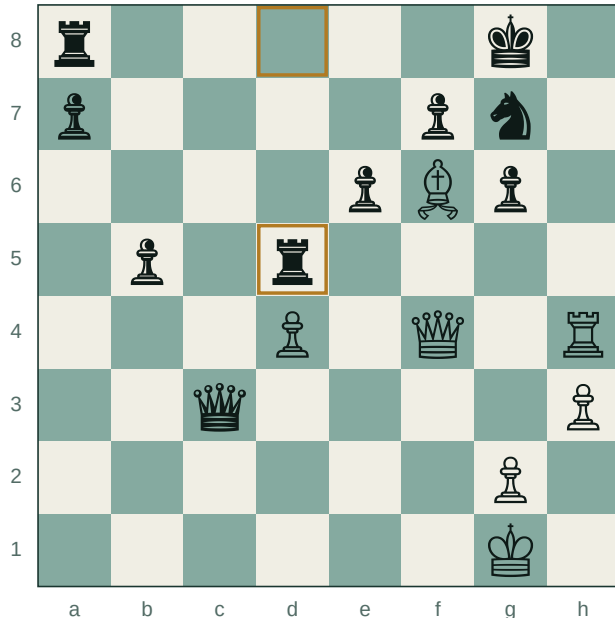


# Mate in three: White, move 36

Mate in three

White to move



Previous move: 35...Rd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**36. Rh8+ Kxh8 37. Qh6+ Kg8 38. Qxg7#**

**36.Rh8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **36...Kxh8**.

**37.Qh6+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h6 it attacks king on h8 and knight on g7. Recorded reply: **37...Kg8**.

**38.Qxg7#** Mate: queen on g7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on c3. Check for tactical protection.